

Final design edits: what was asked, what changed

Ten items from `final_design_edits.md`. Eight changed the site, one needed no change, and one is waiting on you.

2 August 2026 Tests: **114 pass** (9 new) Verified live at **1280px**, **900px**, and in **embed mode**

01 Where a newly clicked chart lands

CHANGED

The logic of adding charts to national and state isn't clear; sometimes they show up near the top and sometimes it seems random.

It wasn't random: cards rendered in category order, alphabetical within. Clicking "Coffee" inserted it into the Food block, often several screens below the fold, so the click read as doing nothing.

Now the grid orders **most recently added first**, on National and My State. A group header add puts the whole group on top in the order the rail lists it. The first paint and Select all still lay out in category order, since nothing is "most recent" there. Compare and Map are untouched.

index.html

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selAdd

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selRemove

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NationalView,

StateView

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tests/helpers.test.js

— 5

new

tests

Can each category get a color assigned? Seeing blues and purples mixed in "Bills & getting around", legacy labels like "Work and Wages" under "Rent and homes", and two colors in "Paychecks & debt".

Your hunch was right, this landed in the previous pass. Checked against the rendered page: Food `#ebc382` , Bills `#472b51` , Health `#b0645f` , Paychecks `#70ad8f` , Rent & homes `#2c3254` , one color per category with no exceptions. "Work & Wages" survives only in a code comment in `fetch_data.R` and in `picker_mockups.html` ; it can't reach the app. The two colors in Paychecks & debt are the up/down change badges, red and green, not the category color.

Your call, not changed. The Bills purple `#472b51` sits close to the Rent & homes navy `#2c3254` at chart-line weight, which is the most likely source of "blues and purples mixed." Separating them is a one-line edit to `ESP_CATEGORY_COLOR` . Say the word and I'll move Bills toward a clearly violet purple.

`index.html`

— no
change
made

Since Jan 2025 on the Census categories, where the last data is 2024, make the graphic more obviously blank. The y-axis implies something is wrong.

Four national series publish nothing on or after Jan 2025: 20th-percentile income, rent burden, uninsured rate, and median household income. The anchor clamped back to the last 2024 reading and Chart.js painted a full y-axis around that one point.

The canvas is now replaced by a dashed blank panel that names the gap: **"No data since Jan 2025 — Last published 2024."** In %-change mode the headline shows an em-dash instead of "+0.0%", which was claiming "unchanged" right beside a note saying there had been no reading at all. A duplicate "Data through 2024" that printed twice on the same card is gone.

index.html

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emptyWindowNote

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ChartCard

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tests/helpers.test.js

— 4

new

tests

To blend with the Resources template, the background for all sections except the white data display area should be #FFFDF2: the left rail, the top menu button area, and the area surrounding the tables.

Done, and it was an inversion rather than a tint. The page was beige #f4f2e4 with cream panels, and the card interiors were transparent, so the charts were the same color as the page. Now the surround is #FFFDF2 — page, rail, menu bars, state selector, footer — and only the data panels are white: the card grid, the heatmap, the map and bar chart, the Compare panels, the annual stat tiles, the About tables.

Applied in **embed mode too**. Embed previously did the opposite (white page, cream panels), which would have put a white iframe on a #FFFDF2 ESP page. `about.html` got the same split so the two pages match.

`index.html`

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`SURFACE`

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`PAGE_BG`

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`MENU_BG`

, ~14

panel

sites

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`about.html`

05

Feedback address

PLACEHOLDER

We need an email address for receiving feedback, on the main page and on the about page. Start with "TKTKATESP" as a bad email.

Two places: the footer on every view, reading "Found an error? TKTKATESP", and the corrections note at the bottom of the About page, which now reads "Corrections and questions are welcome: write to TKTKATESP."

Left as plain text rather than a `mailto:` link, since a compose window addressed to nothing is worse than no link. It's deliberately not a valid address so it can't ship quietly. Grep `TKTKATESP` to find both.

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index.html
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FEEDBACK_EMAIL
, footer
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assets/about_content.js
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06

Hairlines under the menu bars

CHANGED

The thin grey lines should track the window, set to the side rail plus the tables, not extend to the left and right as currently configured.

The bars are full-bleed, so a plain `border-bottom` ran the rule window edge to window edge while everything it separates starts 56px in. The rule is now drawn by an inset pseudo-element that rides the same responsive padding the content column uses, 56px above 960px, then 24px, then 16px.

Measured at 1280px: the rule runs 56 → 1209, the rail's left edge is at 56, and the card grid's right edge is at 1209. Exact. Applied to the global controls bar, the state selector bar, and the embed tab bar.

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index.html
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.at-
inset-
rule
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The map gradient should not be red but more like dark navy, specifically #2c3254 at the full. Style the hover card more like the reddish color it is now.

The ramp runs pale blue #d3dcf0 to #2c3254, bent through a more saturated mid so the middle of the scale stays blue instead of going gray. The no-data gray is unchanged and now separates from the ramp by hue as well as value. The sorted bar chart and the legend follow the same ramp automatically.

The hover card is warm red. One adjustment worth knowing: cream text on the brand #E04E39 is 3.87:1, under WCAG AA, and every line in that card is 10 to 12px. I deepened it to #C43F2C, which is 5.03:1, and warmed the two secondary text colors that were tuned for the old navy fill.

index.html

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LEVEL_RAMP

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MAP_TIP

Title suggestion: Economic Security Project's Affordability Tracker. Add to embed, remove the old text, change the structure if necessary.

The title and subtitle lived in the standalone-only navy hero, so on the ESP page — the tracker's actual home — a reader saw a bare row of tabs and the site never named itself. The masthead now renders in **both modes**: navy on the standalone page, the same words in the light palette above the tabs in embed.

Removed as instructed: the kicker "The Affordability Tracker · 2026" and the headline "What's gotten more expensive." The old dek about federal price data is gone too, replaced by the new subtitle. The browser tab title and about.html's kicker match.

index.html

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SITE_TITLE

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masthead,

styles.h1Embed

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about.html

Remove the "couple of clicks" sentence. Check it more generally for AI-slop and clean it up to sound more human.

Sentence removed. The rest held up better than expected, so this was a light pass of about eighteen edits, not a rewrite. What went: stock lead-ins ("One gap worth knowing before you quote it", "One constraint shapes this whole section"), rhetorical em-dashes throughout, and "changes that fall apart under scrutiny."

What stayed: every "X, not Y" line that carries a real definition, such as "per person with a credit file, not per resident" and "an artifact of reporting rules, not an absence of medical debt." Those are the cautions a reader needs, not a tic. No empirical claim, source, definition, or date changed.

assets/about_content.js

— shared

by

about.html

and the

in-app

About

view

Subtitle options — what are your thoughts?

Went with your first option, verbatim: **"Follow the costs shaping household budgets, using public data to understand what is changing, where, and by how much."**

It was the only one of the three that says what the thing does and what it's for, and "what is changing, where, and by how much" maps onto National, My State, and Compare. The third asserted that life is unaffordable, which is an editorial claim the data on the page doesn't establish and the kind of line a hostile reader uses to dismiss the whole tracker.

index.html

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SITE_SUBTITLE

Waiting on you

- **The email.** TKTKATESP is in two places and is not a valid address. Nothing else blocks launch.
- **Bills purple vs. Rent & homes navy.** Flagged in item 02. One line if you want them further apart.
- **The title wraps to two lines** at 1280px on the standalone page, which reads fine. In embed it fits on one. Worth a look on the real ESP page before launch, since the iframe width there is what actually decides it.